

ID: SOMA-M-P04

Title: Mindful Drinking

Duration: 9m 59s (715 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore the act of drinking a beverage with awareness. This is a way of slowing down and paying attention to an ordinary activity in daily life. You can use any drink you have nearby – water, tea, coffee, juice, or anything else that feels nourishing. Please avoid alcohol for this exercise.

Most of the time, when we drink, we are doing other things at the same time. We may be talking, scrolling on our phones, or thinking ahead to what is coming next. This practice is a gentle invitation to pause and be with the experience of drinking a beverage as you take each sip. There is no special skill required, and nothing to achieve. The invitation is to be curious about the experience of drinking, from beginning to end.

You can be wherever you are comfortable – sitting, standing, or resting. For the next few minutes, your drink will support you in being present through attending to sight, touch, smell, and taste. When you're ready, begin with a simple check in with yourself. Notice the kind of energy you are arriving with -- perhaps calm, tired, restless, alert, or something else. There is no right way to feel.

[Short Pause] (10s - Settling in)

Now with the drink in front of you, let your eyes explore the drink in its container – whether it's a cup, glass, bottle, or something else. Allow your eyes to take in what is here, at your own pace.

[Short Pause] (10s - Visual observation)

Now, you may wish to hold the drink in your hands. Notice the weight. Notice how your fingers are wrapped around it. Is the surface of the container smooth or textured? Is it warm or cool? Allow your hands and palms to explore what it feels like to hold this object.

[Short Pause] (10s - Tactile observation)

When you're ready, bring the drink toward your nose. Take simple breaths and notice any scent. The aroma may be strong or faint. It may feel pleasant, or not so pleasant, or neutral. Whatever is present is a part of the experience. If the smell feels strong, feel free to hold the drink further away. You might also notice the absence of scent, and that, too, is a valid sensory experience.

[Short Pause] (10s - Olfactory observation)

Before taking a sip, bring curiosity to your body – feel your posture, the support of the chair or the floor, the rhythm of your breathing. Notice your mouth and lips.

Now, take a small sip of the drink. Notice how the liquid comes in contact with your lips, your tongue, the inside of the mouth. You might pay attention to temperature, and texture. Does it feel cool, or warm? Perhaps the liquid feels smooth or thick or light. You might also bring

awareness to taste, scents, and flavors. As you slowly swallow, bring curiosity to how the liquid moves through your throat and into your body.

[Long Pause] (25s - First sip and swallow)

Feel free to pause for a few moments before taking the next sip. Notice what may be lingering in the mouth – perhaps the flavours remain, perhaps they are fading away. Notice how the body is feeling right now.

[Short Pause] (10s - Sensory observation)

When you feel ready, take another sip. Explore again how the beverage feels, tastes, and moves in the mouth and body. Each sip may be similar or different. Observe what is present in this moment.

[Long Pause] (25s - Second sip and swallow)

As you continue with this practice, your attention may wander. Thoughts and feelings may arise, and that is okay. When you notice this happening, return to the drink. Feel the texture and temperature of the container at the hands, notice the scents, attend to tastes. Choose whichever sense feels the easiest to connect with.

[Short Pause] (10s - Sensory observation)

As you attend to this drinking experience, you might become aware of emotions, memories, or images connected to drinking. These can be acknowledged without needing to explore them further right now. You can simply guide your attention back to the senses whenever it feels manageable.

[Short Pause] (10s - Short pause)

When you feel ready, place your drink down gently. Notice how your body feels now. Perhaps there is an aftertaste in the mouth or maybe there are lingering sensations in the throat. Take a few moments to be with what is present for you in the body.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Feel free to take a slow deep breath and allow this practice to come to a close.

Thank you for your practice.

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